

Monitors

17-inch CRT monitors

BenQ V773

Specs: 0.27 mm dot pitch, 16-inch viewable area, maximum resolution of 1280 x 1024 @ 60 Hz, 110 MHz bandwidth.

Our Verdict: Priced affordably, the BenQ V773 is a good buy. The maximum resolution of 1280 x 1024 @ 60Hz, viewable area of 16 inches and the dot pitch of 0.27 is reasonable at best. Geometrical distortions are negligible, and brightness and contrast is perfect—with no need to boost the gamma when playing dark games.

Runner-up:
Philips 107ES



19-inch CRT monitors

Philips 109P4

Specs: 0.25 mm dot pitch, Aperture Grille, 1920 x 1440 @ 60 Hz maximum resolution, 261 MHz video bandwidth.

Our Verdict: The Philips 109P4 is an excellent 19-inch monitor that you can invest in without hesitation. The 109P4 uses an Aperture Grille tube that guarantees a crisp and bright display. Excellent colour saturation, good contrast and high brightness make the Philips 109P4 suitable for most 3D applications and graphics requirements. In the geometry test, the 109P4 performed extremely well, and so we recommend it for designers, who require precision.

Runner-up:
Philips 109ES



Monitors (LCD)

15-inch LCD Monitors

CMV-CT522A

Specs: 500:1 contrast ratio, 250 cd/m² luminance, 16 ms response time and inbuilt speakers

Our Verdict: Excellent colour reproduction, reasonable brightness, superb contrast ratio and a good set of features make the CMV-CT522A a perfect 15-inch LCD monitor to invest in.

Runner-up:
CMV-CT522A



17-inch LCD monitors

Samsung SyncMaster 173P

Specs: 700:1 contrast ratio, 270 cd/m² luminance, 25 ms response time and swivel base

Our Verdict: Samsung's SyncMaster 173P comes out as the best-designed LCD monitor. The 700:1 contrast ratio gives it an edge over other LCDs. However, the 25 ms response time makes it unsuitable for gaming. Performance on all other aspects is top-notch.

Runner-up:
CMV-CT722A



Flashback To December 2000

ViewSonic PS775

Specs: 0.22 mm dot pitch, 16-inch viewable area, 1600 x 1200 @ 76Hz and 150 MHz bandwidth.

Evolution: ViewSonic's PS775 was way ahead of the competition in its time. Acceptance of 17-inch monitors has increased, and this mass adoption has lowered prices. However, price cuts simply mean curtailing of high-end specifications. Hence, as of today, one can buy three 17-inch monitors for the price at which the ViewSonic PS775 was offered then. Also, new technologies such as full-flat tubes have percolated into mass

market products.

LCD Monitors

Evolution: Four years ago, LCD panels were simply too expensive for the masses. The manufacturing costs of LCD panels were very high. With rapid development of better fabrication technologies, manufacturing costs were brought down. As of today, you can get a 14-inch LCD panel for as less as Rs 13,000, which is terrific considering the fact that the same panel was priced at Rs 40,000 odd four years ago.

